

127. Word Ladder

begin: str

end: str

word_list

transform: adjacent pair words differ by a single letter

Reframe as a graph problem

Nodes: begin + end + word

Edges: undirected adj_list build from comparing every node in the graph to each other $O(\text{wordlist})$

OR

computing every possible one edit off word + check if in word_list $O(26 \cdot \text{len}(\text{word}))$

$O(\text{wordlist}^2)$ vs $O(26 \cdot \text{len}(\text{word}) \cdot \text{wordlist})$